Episode 5: The 3-AM Checkout



Programming with Python · Tutorial 05

At 3 AM, on his fourth energy drink, Tobi rewrote the entire checkout “to make it faster.” This morning the health inspector called to announce a surprise visit, and the register is a minefield of crashes. In this notebook you learn to work *with* things going wrong: read a **traceback** (Python’s crash report), catch failures with **try/except**, let your own code refuse bad input with **raise**, guard invariants with **assert**, and debug Tobi’s 3-AM checkout line by line. It’s the last lab of Part I. Next session opens with Checkpoint 3, which is still AI-free.

Work on the notebook

Open in browser 

Open in browser (recommended): runs entirely on your machine, in this tab: no account, no installation, and after it loads no internet is needed.

> ! **How your work is saved (read this once)**
> Your progress lives **in this browser tab**. If you **reload** the page (Cmd/Ctrl + R) your work is still there. But if you **close the tab and open the link again later, you start from a clean notebook**. There is no cross-device sync in the browser, and clearing browser data or private mode also wipes it.
>
> So: **download your `.py` before you leave**: press **Cmd/Ctrl+S**, then menu → Download → *Download Python code*. Without the save, the file is empty or misses your last edits. That download is the *only* guaranteed copy. Handing in files works exactly like this in the checkpoints, so you get to practice the motion every week. Note: labs are not graded and nothing is handed in. The downloaded `.py` is your backup. You can’t upload it back into the browser editor.

Open in molab: marimo’s free cloud (account required). Your copy saves to your account and reopens on **any device**. Choose this if you know you’ll switch computers or want to be certain nothing is lost. Optional: nothing graded ever requires it.

Bibliography